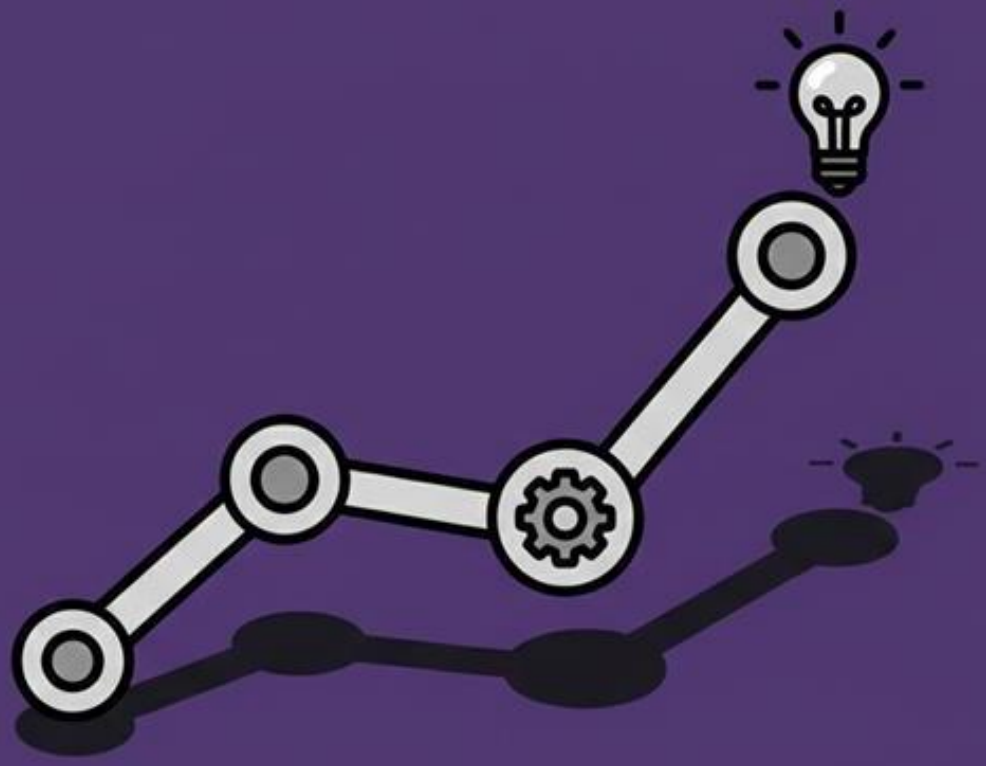

Professional Development Policy

mitsogo

Document Control

Information:

Title	Classification	Version	Status
Professional Development policy	Internal Document	1.0	Validated

Review Verification and Approval:

Version	Authors	Approved by	Issue date	Status
1.0	Neetha M S	Monica Mathias Seigell	01st Jan 2026	Approved

1. Introduction

At Hexnode, we believe that investing in our employees' continuous learning is critical to building a skilled, engaged, and future-ready workforce. The Professional Development Policy enables employees to enhance their competencies through educational programs while aligning their growth with the organization's long-term objectives.

Hexnode is committed to fostering a culture of continuous learning and growth. The purpose of this policy is to support employee upskilling and professional advancement by offering financial assistance for relevant degree programs and certification courses. The policy ensures alignment between employee development and the company's strategic objectives.

This policy outlines the process, financial assistance, and conditions for employees seeking to pursue higher education or certification programs, with an annual reimbursement cap of ₹50,000.

2. Market Trends & Industry Benchmarking

In today's rapidly evolving technology landscape, continuous learning is essential.

Leading organizations in India and globally invest significantly in employee development to:

- Bridge skill gaps in emerging areas like AI, cloud computing, and data analytics.
- Retain talent by supporting career advancement opportunities.
- Foster innovation and agility through a culture of learning.

3. Policy Objectives

- Support employees in upskilling and reskilling relevant to their roles.
- Enhance employee engagement, satisfaction, and retention.
- Promote a culture of lifelong learning and innovation.
- Ensure responsible organizational investment in professional development.

4. Scope and Eligibility

- Applies to all permanent employees of Hexnode graded **A2 and above** who have completed **2 years of services** with Hexnode and above 4 star rating in the performance matrix.
- Courses must align with the employee's current role or approved career path.
- Employees under performance improvement plans or disciplinary review are **ineligible**.
- The course must be **relevant** to the employee's current role or a role identified in their career development plan.
- The institution must be **recognized by national or international accreditation bodies**.
- Approval must be obtained **prior to course enrollment**.

5. Eligible Programs

5.1 Master's Degree Programs

- MBA or equivalent degrees from accredited institutions.
- Flexible learning modes including part-time, weekend, or online programs.
- Typical duration: 2 years (4 semesters).

5.2 Professional Certification Programs

- Short-term certification courses from recognized bodies and e-learning platforms.
- Course relevance to employee's current or targeted roles is mandatory.

6. Financial Assistance Framework

6.1 Annual Reimbursement Cap

- Maximum of ₹50,000 per employee per financial year for all approved courses combined.
- Unused amounts cannot be carried forward to the next year.

6.2 Master's Program Reimbursement

- Reimbursement disbursed semester-wise, up to ₹25,000 per semester.
- Total maximum of ₹50,000 reimbursed per year.
- Total possible reimbursement of ₹1,00,000 over the typical 2-year duration.

6.3 Certification Program Reimbursement

- Up to ₹50,000 reimbursed annually upon successful course completion.
- Reimbursement requires submission of payment proof and certification.

7. Application and Approval Process

- Employees submit applications detailing course content, fees, and justification for relevance.
- Manager reviews application considering employee performance, course relevance, and business needs.
- Final approval by HR based on budget and policy compliance.
- In some cases, employees may be required to present their learning plan or attend an interview.

8. Terms and Conditions

8.1 Commitment and Retention

- For master's programs, employees must commit to a minimum 24-months service post completion.

- For certification programs, a 12-month minimum retention period is required post completion.

- Repayment Clause

  In the event that an employee leaves the company prior to the completion of the mandatory service retention period, the following repayment obligations apply;

Separation Criteria	Repayment Obligation
Voluntary Resignation	If an employee resigns voluntarily during the retention period, they are liable to repay 100% of the total programme fees incurred by the company
Termination of Employment	If an employee is terminated during the retention period, they are liable to fully repay the total cost of the course availed.

8.2 Reimbursement Process

- Employees must provide receipts, mark sheets or certificates, and proof of fee payment.
- Reimbursements processed within 30 days of valid documentation submission.
- Failure to complete the program results in loss of reimbursement and repayment obligations.

8.3 Work and Study Balance

- Study leave of up to 1 day per semester may be granted at manager discretion.
- Employees must ensure their work performance and responsibilities are not adversely affected.

9. Exclusions

- Courses unrelated to the employee's role or Hexnode's strategic business objectives.
- Education pursued prior to employment or during probation.
- Non-accredited institutions or unrecognized certifications.

10.Administrative Oversight

- HR manages policy implementation and budget allocation.
- Utilization and impact reviewed annually.
- Policy subject to revision based on organizational needs and market trends.

11.Governance and Approval Structure

The following governance structure ensures appropriate oversight and alignment with organizational goals for all professional development requests;

1. **First Level Approval: Respective Reporting Manager** – Validates business relevance and employee eligibility.
2. **Second Level Approval: Learning and Development (L&D)** – Verifies policy compliance and budget availability.
3. **Final Review and Approval: Monica, General Manager, HR** – Grants final authorization for the programme

12.Policy Review and Amendments

Hexnode reserves the right to modify, amend, or terminate this policy at any time with appropriate communication to employees.

13.Contact Information

For queries and applications, employees should contact the HR department.